STOWZA · PUBLISHING

Listing Requirements, Rates & Alternatives

Exactly what each store asks for, what the standard path costs, and every cheaper option — in one place.

LISTING ITEMS	STANDARD RATE	BEST ALTERNATIVE	COMMISSION
34	₹2,972/mo	₹826/mo	0%

29 September 2026. Every specification, character limit, price and policy quote below was read from the vendor's own documentation today — sources in §9. Converted at ₹88 to the dollar. Where Stowza already has an asset, it is marked; where it does not, the gap is named.

1. How to read this

Three parts, in the order you asked for them.

PART	SECTIONS	WHAT IT ANSWERS
Listing points	§2 Google Play §3 App Store §4 Our gaps	Every field, asset and declaration each store demands, with exact sizes and character limits. §4 marks which we already have.
Normal rates	§5 Standard path §6 Commission	What it costs if you take the obvious route and pay list price for everything.
Alternatives	§7 Line by line §8 Three stacks	A cheaper or better option at every line, and what the totals become.

2. Listing points — Google Play

17 items. Sizes and limits are Google's published values.

Graphic assets

ASSET	EXACT SPEC	HAVE IT?	NOTE
App icon	512 × 512 px, 32-bit PNG **with** alpha, max 1024 KB	ADAPT	We have the adaptive launcher icon set in the app; the store icon is a separate 512×512 export.
Feature graphic	1024 × 500 px, JPEG or 24-bit PNG, **no** alpha	MAKE	The banner at the top of the listing. Not yet produced.
Screenshots	Minimum 2. JPEG or 24-bit PNG, no alpha. Min side 320 px, max side 3840 px, and the long side may not exceed twice the short side. Google recommends ≥4 at 1080 px.	HAVE	The launch-film frames are 1080 × 1920 — inside every limit and exactly the recommended size.
Promo video	YouTube URL	HAVE	Optional. The 24-second launch film can be uploaded and linked.

Text fields

FIELD	LIMIT	NOTE
App title	30 chars	"Stowza" leaves room for a descriptor, e.g. *Stowza: Send parcels by car* (27).
Short description	80 chars	Shown before the fold. This is the one that converts.
Full description	4,000 chars	Indexed for search. Google suggests under 1,000 is fine if it explains the app.

Declarations and account

- **Developer account** — organisation type, verified, D-U-N-S number.
- **Signed Android App Bundle** (`.aab`) — not an APK.
- **Package name** — `in.stowza.app`, permanent once published.
- **Target API 36** — required for new apps and updates from 31 August 2026. ALREADY MET
- **Privacy policy URL** — public, crawlable.
- **Data Safety form** — the five categories in §4.
- **Content rating questionnaire** — declare in-app messaging.

- **Target audience & ads declaration.**
- **App access** — reviewer sign-in. DEMO BUILD COVERS IT
- **Financial features declaration** — the wallet and UPI flows.
- **Account-deletion URL** — web page matching the in-app path.
- **Countries, pricing, and a release track.**

---

3. Listing points — Apple App Store

17 items. Apple is stricter on image sizes: there is no "roughly this big".

Graphic assets

ASSET	EXACT SPEC	HAVE IT?	NOTE
App icon	1024 × 1024 px, no alpha, no transparency	ADAPT	Set in App Store Connect, separate from the in-app icon.
Screenshots	**6.9"** — 1260 × 2736 portrait (iPhone 17/16/15 Pro Max, Plus) **6.5"** — 1284 × 2778 portrait (fallback; scales up) 1–10 per display type, JPEG/PNG, **no alpha**	RE-RENDER	**Our 1080 × 1920 frames are not a valid App Store size.** They pass on Play and fail here — Apple accepts only its listed dimensions. Fix: re-render the launch composition at 1260 × 2736.
iPad screenshots	13" — 2064 × 2752 11" — 1488 × 2266	DECIDE	**Required only if the app runs on iPad.** Declaring iPhone-only avoids this entirely — worth doing unless iPad matters.
App preview video	Up to 3 per display type	HAVE	Optional. The launch film would need re-rendering to a valid size.

Text fields

FIELD	LIMIT	NOTE
App name	30 chars	Minimum 2. Same discipline as Play.
Subtitle	30 chars	Sits under the name. Play has no equivalent.
Keywords	100 chars	Comma-separated, hidden from users. Play has no equivalent — Play indexes the description instead.
Promotional text	170 chars	Editable without a new build. Good for "now live in Bangalore–Mysore".
Description	4,000 chars	Same as Play.

Declarations and account

- **Apple Developer Program** — organisation enrolment, legal entity, D-U-N-S, authority to bind the company.
- **Bundle ID** — `in.stowza.app`, already set. HAVE
- **App Store Connect record** + version and build number.
- **Age rating questionnaire.**
- **App Privacy details** — Apple's nutrition labels, the same five categories.
- **Encryption / export compliance** — the app uses HTTPS and OTP; normally the exempt standard-encryption answer, but it must be answered.
- **Privacy policy URL, support URL, marketing URL.**
- **Sign-in details for the reviewer.**
- **Category** — primary and optional secondary.

- **Pricing and availability, and copyright line.**

4. What Stowza still needs

Read from the repository today. Most of the list is done.

ITEM	STATUS	DETAIL
Android screenshots	DONE	1080 × 1920 frames from the launch film. Valid and recommended size.
Promo video	DONE	24-second launch film with poster frame.
Reviewer access	DONE	Demo build self-signs in, own package id.
Account deletion (in-app)	DONE	Settings → Delete my account.
Target API 36	DONE	Already compliant with the 31 Aug 2026 rule.
iOS bundle ID + icon set	DONE	`in.stowza.app`, deployment target iOS 15.0.
iOS screenshots	RE-RENDER	Need 1260 × 2736. Our frames are 1080 × 1920. One re-render of the existing composition.
iOS app version	SYNC	Still 1.2.0 while Android is 1.3.1 — the iOS target predates the redesign.
iOS location declaration	FIX	`Info.plist` declares `NSLocationAlwaysAndWhenInUse`, claiming background location the app does not use. A likely rejection and a wrong privacy answer.
Feature graphic 1024×500	MAKE	Play only. Not yet produced.
Store icons (512, 1024)	EXPORT	Source art exists; needs two exports at the right sizes without alpha where required.
Privacy / terms / deletion pages	PUBLISH	Copy exists in-app. Needs to be on the web.
Android release signing key	CREATE	Yours to generate. Gradle is wired.

5. Normal rates — the standard path

What it costs if you take the obvious route and pay list price everywhere.

ITEM	RATE	BASIS
Google Play registration	$25 ₹2,200	**One-time.** Never renews.
Apple Developer Program	$99/yr ₹8,712	Annual. Lapses and the app is pulled.
Apple Developer Enterprise	$299/yr	Internal distribution only — **not usable for a consumer app.**
Hosting Vercel Pro	$20/mo ₹1,760	Free tier is "for personal, non-commercial use", so a paid plan is mandatory once you charge.
Email Resend	$20/mo ₹1,760	After the free 3,000/month.
Crash reporting Sentry	$26/mo ₹2,288	After 5,000 events/month.
Geocoding + routing	₹1,000–4,300/mo	Paid provider or a self-hosted VPS.
OTP store	~₹100/mo	Managed Redis.
Domain	~₹100/mo	Annual fee shown monthly.
Payment gateway India	~2% + GST	Per transaction. About ₹1.85 on a ₹79 delivery.
Standard monthly, all list price	**₹2,972+**	**Plus ₹10,912 of first-year account fees.**

6. Commission — the rule that saves you 15–30%

The biggest number on the page is the one you will not pay. Both stores put it in writing.

Standard rates for digital goods: Google charges 15% on the first $1M of a developer's annual revenue and 30% above it, with subscriptions at 15% regardless. Apple's structure is comparable.

Neither applies to Stowza. Google's payments policy exempts:

> "payment is primarily for the purchase or rental of physical goods … for the purchase of physical services (such as transportation services, cleaning services, airfare, gym memberships, food delivery, tickets for live events)"

Apple's App Review Guideline **3.1.3(e)** goes further — it does not merely permit external payment, it **requires** it:

> "If your app enables people to purchase physical goods or services that will be consumed outside of the app, you must use purchase methods other than in-app purchase to collect those payments, such as Apple Pay or traditional credit card entry."

WHAT THIS MEANS IN MONEY

A parcel carried from Bangalore to Mysore is a physical service consumed outside the app. Stowza takes payment through UPI or an Indian gateway and pays the stores **nothing per transaction** — only the gateway's ~2%. On ₹10 lakh of annual delivery revenue that is the difference between paying roughly ₹20,000 in gateway fees and ₹1.5–3 lakh in store commission.

It flips the moment you sell something consumed inside the app — a subscription, priority matching, a paid tier. That revenue must go through store billing at 15–30%. Model it before building it.

7. Alternatives — line by line

A cheaper or better option at every recurring line. All verified today.

NEED	STANDARD	ALTERNATIVE	SAVING	CATCH
Maps, geocoding, routing	Paid provider ₹1,000–4,300	**Ola Maps** — 5,000,000 free API calls/month	₹1,000–4,300	India-focused, which suits us. Free tier is policy, not contract.
Hosting	Vercel Pro ₹1,760	**Cloudflare Workers** — free to 100k req/day, then $5/mo	₹1,320–1,760	Porting the API costs ~2 days. Don't do it right before launch.
iOS builds	Buy a Mac ₹60,000+	**Codemagic** — 500 free macOS min/month, then $0.095/min	₹60,000	A build is 10–15 min, so 30–50 free releases a month.
Crash reporting	Sentry ₹2,288	**Firebase Crashlytics** — free, no event cap	₹2,288	Ties you to Firebase, which we want anyway for push.
Email	Resend ₹1,760	**Brevo** — 300/day free forever **ZeptoMail** — ~₹286 per 10,000	₹1,474–1,760	Deliverability depends on warming the domain, whoever you use.
Android distribution	Play only	**+ Indus Appstore** — no listing fee, no commission, ~100M Indian devices	₹0 extra reach	A second listing to maintain. Fee waiver is current policy.
iOS soft launch	Wait for review	**TestFlight** — up to 10,000 external testers, included in the $99	weeks earlier	Builds expire after 90 days.
OTP store	Upstash ₹100	Cloudflare KV	₹100	Only worth it if you move hosting too.

8. Three stacks, costed

	STANDARD	RECOMMENDED	LEANEST
Hosting	Vercel ₹1,760	Vercel ₹1,760	Cloudflare ₹0
Maps / routing	₹1,000	Ola ₹0	Ola ₹0
Email	Resend ₹1,760	Brevo ₹0	Brevo ₹0
Crash reporting	Sentry ₹2,288	Crashlytics ₹0	Crashlytics ₹0
iOS builds	₹2,500	Codemagic ₹0	Codemagic ₹0
OTP store	₹100	₹100	₹0
Domain	₹100	₹100	₹100
Apple, monthly equivalent	₹726	₹726	₹726
Monthly	**₹10,234**	**₹2,686**	**₹826**
First year incl. ₹28,000 setup	**₹150,800**	**₹60,200**	**₹37,900**

WHICH ONE I WOULD PICK

Recommended, at ₹2,686 a month. It takes every free tier that costs nothing to adopt — Ola Maps, Brevo, Crashlytics, Codemagic — and leaves the one migration that carries risk. Moving off Vercel saves another ₹1,760 but means rewriting working API routes in the weeks before a launch, which is the wrong order. Do it in month four and land at the leanest column.

9. Sources

Every figure, size, limit and quote above was read from these pages on 29 September 2026.

- Play graphic asset requirements — icon 512×512 32-bit PNG ≤1024 KB; feature graphic 1024×500; screenshots min 2, 320–3840 px, long side ≤ 2× short side.
- Play store listing best practices — title 30, short description 80, full description 4,000 characters.
- Play registration — $25 one-time; personal accounts after 13 Nov 2023 face testing requirements.
- Play service fees — 15% on the first $1M/year, 30% above; subscriptions 15%.
- Play payments policy — physical goods and physical services exempt from Play Billing.
- App Store screenshot specifications — 6.9" 1260×2736; 6.5" 1284×2778; 1–10 per display type; no alpha.
- App Store Connect app information — name 30, subtitle 30, keywords 100, promotional text 170, description 4,000.
- App Review Guidelines 3.1.3(e) — goods and services consumed outside the app must use payment methods other than in-app purchase.
- Apple Developer Program — $99/year; Enterprise $299/year; TestFlight up to 10,000 external testers.
- Vercel pricing — Hobby "for personal, non-commercial use"; Pro $20/month.
- Cloudflare Workers pricing — free to 100,000 requests/day; paid from $5/month.
- Ola Maps pricing — 5 million free API calls per month.
- Codemagic pricing — 500 free macOS M2 minutes/month, then $0.095/minute.
- Zoho ZeptoMail pricing — about $3.25 per 10,000 emails.
- Indus Appstore developer platform — zero listing fee, zero commission.

Two standing caveats. Free tiers are current policy, not contracts — Indus in particular reserves the right to introduce fees with notice. And store rules move: the Android target-API level, Google's testing

requirements and Apple's declarations all changed within the last year, so re-read the live requirement in each console the week you submit.